and Windows 7 also behave differently. Windows 98 would be an alien to all the ones mentioned till now. Different operating systems behave differently and have varying hardware requirements. Although virtualization software just emulates the hardware, telling it the operating system you're going to use is a Guest will still help you. It helps the software determine the "recommended" resource allocation to be done such as hard disk space, memory to be allocated, amount of video memory, hardware accelerations and so on.

The virtual machine software (virtualization software) would give better performance when you tell it about the guest OS than if you don't. For example, while Windows depends on Registry heavily, Linux depends on configuration files. Both serve the same purpose but the frequency and speed with which the access is required is different. Also the file systems in use by them would differ. Most virtualization software let you know the type and version of OS you're trying to use inside it. Also, the performance would be slightly higher if you provided the right information.

Another point to consider is the 64-bit support for the guest operating systems. While in most cases you'll be able to run a 32-bit guest operating system on a 64-bit host machine, it's not easy to do this when the situation is reversed. There's no way you can ask a 32-bit processor to work in a 64-bit mode. While some virtualization software support this request, some only support it experimentally and others don't support it at all! Lack of support for such features can easily take a toll on your performance or stability. You might encounter freezes, corrupted drivers, hangs and screens of death. Take care of such issues and investigate and search well on the internet before you actually try them out.

Snapshots

Just like a picture demonstrates the environment or the scene the way it was when you clicked it, a snapshot of a virtual machine is a way to demonstrate the machine's state the way it was when you took it. It's one of the most useful features for those who love to experiment. A snapshot in terms of a virtual machine is the way to save a virtual machine's state.

When you take the snapshot, the virtualization software actually freezes the virtual hard disk file and the configuration of the machine at the time you took it. It also ensures that whatever you do after that point doesn't modify the files. What it rather does is create new files which it uses to save the new changes made and the changes you make in the configuration of the